

THE SMART TRAVELER'S CHEAT SHEET

10 things most travelers learn the hard way. You don't have to.

Airports · Hotels · Cruise Ships · Food · Money · Health

Free guide by @thekiramethod · 2026

WHY THIS EXISTS

Most travel advice is obvious. "Keep your valuables safe." Okay, but how?

This cheat sheet is different. Every tip here is specific. You can use it on your next trip, starting today.

These 10 things took me years of travel to learn. Some of them I learned the hard way. I'm putting them all in one place so you don't have to.

AIRPORTS

01 AIRPORT

Thieves love baggage claim

The second you pull your suitcase off the belt, your bag on the floor behind you is wide open. Professional teams work in pairs — one distracts, one grabs. Keep your carry-on on your shoulder. Every single time.

02 AIRPORT

The TSA checkpoint is the highest-theft moment in any airport

You're removing shoes, emptying pockets, managing your laptop — and your phone and wallet are sitting in an open tray you can't see. Put valuables inside your zipped carry-on. Everything goes through as one unit, not scattered in three bins.

HOTELS

03 HOTEL

Always ask for two key cards — even if you're alone

When the front desk hands you one key, anyone nearby knows you're traveling solo. Two keys signals a companion without saying a word. It costs nothing and changes how people read you.

04
HOTEL

Request floors 3 to 6. Never the ground floor

Ground floor rooms are easiest to access through windows and sliding doors. Above floor 6, most fire ladders can't reach. Floors 3–6 is the safety sweet spot every security expert recommends.

CRUISE SHIPS

05
CRUISE

Lock your balcony door every time you leave

Balcony-to-balcony access is how most in-cabin theft happens on cruise ships. Most passengers have no idea this is even possible. Every time you leave your cabin — the sliding door gets locked. No exceptions.

06
CRUISE

Leave your passport on the ship when you go ashore

Carry a photocopy and your cruise card in port. If you get pickpocketed — and it happens more than cruise lines admit — you've lost a photocopy. Not your actual passport.

FOOD ABROAD

07
FOOD

Walk two blocks from the main square

Restaurants right next to tourist attractions often have two menus — a tourist version and a local version. Walk two blocks. The food is better, cheaper, and made for people who eat there every week.

HEALTH

08
HEALTH

Window seat on a long flight = extra radiation

At cruising altitude you're above most of Earth's protective atmosphere. A transatlantic window seat gives you roughly a chest X-ray worth of radiation. For frequent flyers: aisle seat on long-haul cuts cumulative exposure significantly.

09
HEALTH

Never plug your phone into an airport USB port

The FBI has issued repeated warnings about "juice jacking" — malware transferred through public USB ports while your device charges. Use your own wall charger. A USB port you don't own is a port you don't use.

MONEY

10
MONEY

Never bring your regular debit card abroad

A stolen debit card is a direct line to your home bank account. Get a separate travel card with a low daily balance. If it's stolen, you've lost today's spending money — not your savings. Set it up once. Use it every trip.

Want the full picture?

The Solo Traveler's Safety Field Guide

7 chapters. Hotels, airports, cruises, digital safety, money traps. Printable checklist inside — fits in your passport holder.

\$14.90

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